

Study System Guide

How to use every document · your weekly rhythm · what to study when

You already have a full toolkit -- Study Guides, Cram Sheets, the Master Map, Comparison Matrix, Special Points Decoder, Retrieval Packets, PLAs. The tools were never the problem. This guide is the missing piece: which tool to open, in what order, on which day.

This Guide Contains:

What each document type is for, and when to open it

A 60-minute weekly study session template

A course-calendar roadmap: what to study, and which docs to pull, every week

A short page on mindset -- grounded, not hype

This is a reference, not new content to memorize.

Read it once now, then flip back to the roadmap page each week.

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DOCUMENT	CADENCE	WHEN / HOW TO USE IT
Master Map	1x, whole course	The 12-channel skeleton -- sequence, circuits, direction rules. Fill it from memory every session, before anything else.
Comparison Matrix	1x, cumulative	Side-by-side triads + paired-channel table. Use for pattern recognition once 2+ weeks are in the same category (e.g. once you've learned a 2nd Hand-Yin channel).
Study Guide	per week	Reference only -- facts, tables, pathways. Read AFTER you've already tried to recall, to check yourself, not as your first exposure.
Cram Sheet	per week	Night-before density sheet. This is your ANSWER KEY, not your study method -- open it last, not first.
Special Points Decoder (Tiered)	per week	All special-point categories with A/B/C priority tags. Drill Level A until automatic, then B, then C.
PLA / Prep Guide	per wk, pre-lecture	Pre-lecture priming -- confidence ratings, vocab, anticipatory questions, Inter-Quiz. Do Sections A-D before class, Section F after.
Active Retrieval Packet	per week	Closed-book blank-page reconstruction. The actual studying happens here, not in the guides.
Retrieval Answer Key	per week	Checked ONLY after a genuine closed-book attempt at the Retrieval Packet -- never read first.
Practice Draw	per week	Blank pathway silhouettes. Draw from memory, close the slides, draw again, correct in a second color.
Quiz Kit	per week	Standalone practice quiz mimicking the real quiz format.

This is the session structure from the retrieval-practice conversation -- the sequence matters as much as the content. Reference material comes LAST, not first.

0-5 min	Blank-page Master Map Full 12-channel sequence + circuits + direction rules, from memory.
5-15 min	Draw 1-2 channels Practice Draw, closed slides, correct in a 2nd color after.
15-30 min	Closed-note recall Identity, pathway, pair, special points -- say it or write it before checking anything.
30-40 min	Comparison drill Comparison Matrix -- against this week's triad or paired neighbor.
40-50 min	Active Retrieval Packet Closed-book. This is the actual studying.
50-60 min	Check + Cram Sheet Open the Answer Key and Cram Sheet LAST. Mark what you missed -- that's tomorrow's priority.

Weekly cadence: run this session 3-4x per week per active channel-week. The 3 Inter-Quiz/Retrieval sessions for mastery criterion should land on different days, not the same day repeated.

WK	TOPIC	ASSESSMENT	PULL THESE DOCS
1	Channel theory, nomenclature, flow of Qi	--	Week 1 materials
2	LU + LI	Quiz 2	Week 2 Study Guide, Cram, PLA
3	ST + SP	Quiz 3	Week 3 Study Guide, Cram, PLA, Special Points Decoder
4	HT + SI	Quiz 4	Week 4 Study Guide, Cram, Quiz Kit
5	BL + KI	MIDTERM (wks 1-4)	Midterm Kit + Week 5 materials
6	PC + SJ + GB + LR	Quiz 6	Week 6 full set + Tiered Decoder
7	Divergent / Sinew / Cutaneous systems	Quiz 7	Week 7 PLA (build Study Guide after lecture)
8	Eight Extraordinary Vessels	Quiz 8	Build EV package before this week
9	Acupuncture points overview	--	TBD once syllabus confirms
10	Comprehensive review	FINAL	Master Comparison + Comparison Matrix + all Cram Sheets

Weeks 9 topic is provisional pending syllabus confirmation -- Dr. Zhang's Week 1 reading listed week 9 as 'acupuncture points' but this hasn't been confirmed against a Week 8/9 transcript yet.

Low confidence-rating scores at the start of a PLA aren't a bad sign. They're the actual starting measurement. The whole point of a Pre/Post rating is to have something honest to compare against -- a 2 that becomes a 4 by Friday is real progress; a 5 you never earned isn't useful data at all.

The retrieval sessions will feel harder than rereading a Cram Sheet. That's expected, not a signal something's wrong. Recognition (rereading) and recall (blank-page reconstruction) use different memory systems, and only the second one is what a quiz or a real patient actually asks of you.

This system is built around effort you're already putting in -- it's not asking for more hours, it's asking you to spend the hours you already have in a different order. Reference material at the end of a session instead of the start is a small change with a large effect.

Three years from now, a patient is going to describe a pattern of symptoms and you're going to reconstruct the channel pathway in your head before you reach for a book. That's what today's blank-page drawing is actually training -- not this week's quiz, that instinct.

Open the Master Map. Start there. Every session.